

Sober AF Entertainment's "You Got A Peer In Me" Program

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1: Identify your key objectives for your proposal (up to 5). If you've selected more than one strategy area, clarify which area(s) each objective addresses. Include intended short-term and long-term outcomes. Provide additional narrative as needed.

Objective 1: Develop and Expand the Collegiate Recovery Program (CRC) at the University of Northern Colorado (UNCo)

Strategy Area: Prevention, Harm Reduction, Recovery

Short-term Outcomes:

- Establish a comprehensive CRC with increased awareness and participation among UNCo students.
- Increase the availability of recovery support services and resources on campus.

Long-term Outcomes:

- Sustain a thriving CRC that becomes an integral part of campus life, supporting long-term recovery and wellness for students.
- Reduce stigma associated with recovery and increase overall campus health and safety.

Narrative: S.AF.E will leverage its extensive experience and proven strategies to develop a robust CRC at UNCo. This initiative will focus on building a supportive recovery community, increasing awareness among students and staff, and providing essential resources for students in recovery or those interested in sobriety. Collaboration with university and community stakeholders will be key. The CRC will receive funding and S.AF.E's guidance to help enroll new CRC students, organize a series of sober-support events led by students and faculty, and advocate for CRC support in the surrounding Weld community.

Objective 2: Curate, Market, and Execute a Series of 8 CRC-Led Events Promoting Recovery Services, Peer Support, and Harm Reduction on Campus at UNCo

Strategy Area: Prevention, Harm Reduction, Recovery

Short-term Outcomes:

- Successful execution of 8 on-campus events featuring CRC members, student peers, and recovery and harm reduction resources.
- Increase awareness and knowledge about harm reduction and sober living among students.

Long-term Outcomes:

- Increase in the number of students who choose abstinence or stay in recovery from substance use disorders.
- Foster a cultural shift towards accepting and supporting sober lifestyles and harm reduction practices.

Narrative: These events will engage students and community members in fun, substance-free activities while providing education and resources for harm reduction. Collaboratively planned with UNCo students and staff, these events will address the unique needs of the community, promote recovery services, and enhance peer support.

Objective 3: Curate, Market, and Execute a Series of 8 Community-Led Events Promoting Recovery Services, Peer Support, and Harm Reduction at the Greeley Stampede

Strategy Area: Prevention, Harm Reduction, Recovery

Short-term Outcomes:

- Successful execution of 8 off-campus events at the Greeley Stampede, with high student and community participation.
- Increase public awareness of sober activities and recovery support organizations within local communities.

Long-term Outcomes:

- Reduction in opioid use and relapses in Weld County among high-risk groups, thereby reducing opioid overdoses.
- Establishment of regular, sustainable sober events that become integral to recovery community life, fostering a culture of sobriety and support in Weld County.

Narrative: These events will engage students and community members in fun, substance-free activities while providing education and resources for harm reduction. Planned in collaboration with UNCo CRC students and staff, these events will address the unique needs of the community. S.A.F.E will partner with treatment groups, recovery community organizations, and cultural groups for events outside UNCo, providing tickets for staff, students, speakers, and partner clients.

Objective 4: Facilitate Peer Support Internship for UNCo Students

Strategy Area: Prevention, Harm Reduction, Recovery

Short-term Outcomes:

- Certify 10-20 UNCo students as Peer Recovery Specialists.
- Provide internships and peer support opportunities to students, enhancing their skills and professional development.

Long-term Outcomes:

- Build a network of trained peer support specialists who can provide ongoing support within the university and the broader community.
- Enhance career prospects for students in the field of substance use treatment and recovery.

Narrative: By providing internships and COPA-certified peer support training, S.A.F.E will empower students with the skills and experience needed to support their peers. This initiative supports the CRC and contributes to students' personal and professional development. Funded internships and peer training will demonstrate the program's benefits to students and staff and prove that the advantages to UNCo outweigh the program costs. S.A.F.E-trained peer specialists will provide support at UNCo events and the Greeley Stampede, offering crucial peer interactions for those who may be triggered at social events.

Objective 5: Provide Harm Reduction Education, Including Naloxone Training and Distribution

Strategy Area: Prevention, Harm Reduction, Recovery

Short-term Outcomes:

- Train and certify UNCo students and community members in Naloxone administration and harm reduction strategies.
- Distribute Naloxone kits and educational materials at events and through community partners.

Long-term Outcomes:

- Increase community capacity to prevent opioid overdoses and respond effectively in emergency situations.
- Reduce opioid-related harm and fatalities in Weld County.

Narrative: S.A.F.E will leverage its partnership with CDPHE for free Naloxone kits and provide comprehensive training to equip participants with life-saving skills. S.A.F.E staff and peers will conduct harm reduction training on the use of Naloxone in emergency situations and distribute free Naloxone kits to venue staff and attendees. This education is crucial for empowering individuals to respond to opioid overdoses effectively, addressing identified needs for increased harm reduction education and resources in the community.

2: Outline your general timeline, indicating key dates and milestones.

January 2025 Milestone 1: Program Launch

- **Activities:** Official program kick-off meeting with UNCo administration, staff, and student representatives.
- **Outcome:** Establish initial communication and set expectations for the program.

February 2025 Milestone 2: First On-Campus Event

- **Activities:** Curate, market, and execute the first of 8 CRC-led events on campus.
- **Outcome:** Engage students in a fun, substance-free event while promoting the CRC.

March - April 2025 Milestone 3: Ongoing On-Campus Events

- **Activities:** Continue with 2 additional on-campus events each month, providing peer support and harm reduction education.
- **Outcome:** Maintain student engagement and build a supportive community.

Milestone 4: Initial Peer Support Training Sessions

- **Activities:** Begin training sessions for 10-20 UNCo students to become certified Peer Recovery Specialists through S.A.F.E's Peer Recovery Specialist Training program approved by COPA.
- **Outcome:** Equip students with the necessary skills to provide peer support.

May 2025 Milestone 5: Mid-Year Evaluation

- **Activities:** Conduct a comprehensive review of the program's progress, including feedback from participants and stakeholders.
- **Outcome:** Identify areas for improvement and adjust strategies as needed.

June 2025 Milestone 6: Greeley Stampede Event Series

- **Activities:** Curate, market, and execute the first of 8 community-led events at the Greeley Stampede, involving UNCo CRC students, local recovery community, and clients from Centennial Peaks Hospital.
- **Outcome:** Expand program reach beyond campus and engage the wider community.

July - August 2025 Milestone 7: Continued Greeley Stampede Events

- **Activities:** Host an additional event at the Greeley Stampede each month, providing ongoing peer support and harm reduction education.
- **Outcome:** Strengthen community ties and promote substance-free activities.

September - November 2025 Milestone 8: Final On-Campus Events

- **Activities:** Host the remaining on-campus events, continuing peer support and harm reduction education.
- **Outcome:** Maintain momentum and ensure sustained student engagement.

Milestone 9: Final Greeley Stampede Events

- **Activities:** Execute the final event at the Greeley Stampede, incorporating all elements of peer support, harm reduction, and community engagement.
- **Outcome:** Celebrate the success of the program and gather final feedback.

December 2025 Milestone 10: End-of-Year Evaluation & Report

- **Activities:** Conduct a thorough evaluation of the program's impact, including data analysis and feedback collection. Submit final reports to grant funders, including detailed data and analysis. Plan adjustments and improvements for future program iterations.
- **Outcome:** Compile comprehensive reports for stakeholders and grant funders while ensuring transparency and accountability.

Summary: This timeline outlines key dates and milestones for the "You Got A Peer In Me Program," ensuring structured and well-planned activities throughout the grant period. It includes regular data collection, analysis, and reporting to monitor progress and make necessary adjustments to enhance program effectiveness.

3: Identify any current or recent work related to the key strategy area(s) selected above, including work with partners in the community, as applicable.

Sober AF Entertainment (S.AF.E) has been actively engaged in various initiatives that align with the key strategy areas of prevention, harm reduction, and recovery. These initiatives include facilitating events, establishing recovery programs, and providing education and training. Below is a detailed overview of these efforts:

Collegiate Recovery Program (CRC) Development

Current Work: S.AF.E has been instrumental in developing and supporting CRCs at universities across Colorado and beyond. They have successfully collaborated with multiple CRCs to provide essential support for students in recovery, thereby creating a strong network of peer support and resources.

Recent Achievements:

- **Colorado Mesa University:** S.AF.E helped establish a CRC, leading to the successful implementation of 8 events, the training of 10 peer specialists, and the distribution of 200 Naloxone kits. This initiative was funded through Mesa Counties Opioid Abatement Funding.
- **Weld County:** S.AF.E's recent efforts in Weld County include supporting the UNCo Men's Basketball Game vs. Air Force in December 2022, with 170 students and bilingual peer specialists participating.

Community-Led Events Promoting Sober Support and Prevention

Current Work: S.AF.E regularly curates and executes community-led events that provide fun, substance-free environments. These events engage participants and promote sober lifestyles and harm reduction practices. S.AF.E partners with ticketing groups to offer discounted or free tickets for staff, speakers, and partner clients.

Recent Achievements:

- **Concerts and Music Festivals:** Partnered with events such as the Decadence Music Festival, Global Dance Music Festival, Country Jam, The Greeley Stampede, and more, providing sober support tents and harm reduction education.
- **Sports Games:** Collaborated with professional sports teams to host sober tailgates and viewing parties, mainly in Colorado.
- **Virtual Events:** Adapted training programs to virtual formats during the pandemic, reaching over 42,000 people through virtual music festivals in 2020.
- **Greeley Stampede:** Provided Naloxone training, free kits, and peer support at the 2023 and 2024 festivals, interacting with 300 and 450 attendees respectively.

Peer Support and Harm Reduction Education

Current Work: S.AF.E has been at the forefront of providing peer support and harm reduction education through various initiatives. This includes training sessions, workshops, and the distribution of harm reduction materials.

Recent Achievements:

- **Naloxone Distribution and Training:** Distributed nearly 1,000 Naloxone kits and 650 Fentanyl test strips through various programs and events. Conducted 50 Naloxone training sessions to equip community members with the knowledge to prevent opioid overdoses.
- **Peer Support Training:** Implemented peer support specialist training programs certified by the Colorado Providers Association (COPA), aiming to certify 25 specialists by the end of 2025.

Internships and Peer Support Certification

Current Work: S.AF.E offers internships and peer support certification programs to students, providing them with valuable skills and experience in the field of substance use recovery and support.

Recent Achievements:

- **Mesa Training Program:** Pilot program at Colorado Mesa University to certify 10 peer support specialists by 2025.
- **Denver Training Program:** Similar initiative aiming to certify 20 specialists by 2025.
- Collaborated with Mental Health Partners to provide Spanish-speaking peers for Weld County events in 2022-2023.

Data Collection and Program Evaluation

Current Work: S.AF.E employs advanced data collection methods to continuously evaluate and improve programs. This includes using QR code-enabled forms to gather feedback and participant information at events.

Recent Achievements:

- **Streamlined Data Collection System:** Improved S.AF.E's ability to analyze program effectiveness and make data-driven decisions.
- **Comprehensive Reporting:** Developed detailed reports that demonstrate the impact of S.AF.E's programs, ensuring transparency and accountability with stakeholders and funders.

Community Partnerships

Current Work: S.AF.E has established robust partnerships with various organizations to enhance the reach and effectiveness of their programs.

Recent Achievements:

- **Association for Recovery in Higher Education (ARHE):** Collaborated to expand opportunities for students around sober resources, peer support, and harm reduction.
- **Mental Health Partners:** Provided Spanish-speaking peers for events in Weld County.
- **SAFE Project and Shatterproof:** Enhanced opportunities for individuals and students around sober resources and harm reduction.
- **Tribe Recovery and McBride Impact:** Focused on promoting harm reduction and sober support within African American and Latinx communities.

4: Where applicable, describe any challenges or barriers that your entity has experienced in making progress towards these key strategy areas or other considerations.

1. Stigma Around Sobriety and Substance Use

Challenge: S.AF.E faces significant challenges related to the stigma associated with sobriety and substance use. Many individuals are hesitant to participate in sober events or seek help due to fear of judgment and social isolation.

Barrier: This stigma can reduce attendance at events and limit the effectiveness of peer support initiatives.

Strategies to Overcome:

- Promoting a positive and inclusive message around sobriety.
- Showcasing success stories to illustrate the benefits of recovery.
- Creating a supportive community environment where participants feel safe and accepted.

2. Logistical Challenges in Organizing Events

Challenge: Coordinating and executing large-scale events, especially on university campuses and in community settings, involves significant logistical planning. This includes securing venues, managing permits, coordinating with partners, and ensuring adequate resources and staffing.

Barrier: These logistical hurdles can cause delays and increase operational costs.

Strategies to Overcome:

- Employing experienced event planners to manage logistics.
- Collaborating closely with university staff and local organizations.
- Utilizing advanced scheduling and detailed project management to ensure smooth execution of events.

3. Ensuring Consistent Participation and Engagement

Challenge: Maintaining high levels of participation and engagement at events, particularly among college students with many competing interests and commitments, can be difficult.

Barrier: Low turnout at events can undermine program goals and reduce the impact of support services.

Strategies to Overcome:

- Utilizing targeted marketing strategies, including social media outreach and partnerships with student organizations.

- Offering incentives such as free food and entertainment to attract participants.
- Creating engaging events and dynamic programming to retain participant interest.

4. Funding and Resource Limitations

Challenge: Securing sufficient funding and resources to support all program activities and expansion plans is an ongoing challenge. The competitive nature of grant funding and limitations in available financial resources can constrain program growth.

Barrier: Limited funding can restrict the number and scope of events and the ability to hire and train sufficient staff and peer support specialists.

Strategies to Overcome:

- Actively pursuing diverse funding sources, including grants, donations, and partnerships with local businesses and organizations.
- Implementing efficient budget management practices.
- Leveraging in-kind contributions to maximize the impact of available funds.

5. Data Collection and Reporting

Challenge: Collecting accurate and comprehensive data to evaluate program effectiveness and meet reporting requirements can be complex, especially when relying on self-reported information from participants.

Barrier: Incomplete or inaccurate data can hinder the ability to assess program success and make informed decisions for future improvements.

Strategies to Overcome:

- Employing QR code-enabled forms for streamlined data collection, ensuring ease of use for participants and high response rates.
- Training staff and interns to assist in data gathering and verification to ensure accuracy.

5: If your proposal includes facility infrastructure upgrades and/or large capital purchases such as the purchase of land or buildings, provide a detailed and concise explanation about how such a proposed expenditure relates to and addresses your strategies to address and abate opioid use in the county.

Not Applicable

6: Describe the populations to be reached in terms of age, gender identity, race/ethnicity and other relevant information.

1. University of Northern Colorado (UNCo) Students

- **Age:** Primarily 18-25 years old, including traditional undergraduate students and some graduate students aged 26-30.
- **Gender Identity:** Inclusive of all gender identities, with specific outreach to female, male, transgender, non-binary, and gender non-conforming students.
- **Race/Ethnicity:** Diverse student body, including but not limited to:
 - White/Caucasian
 - Hispanic/Latino
 - African American
 - Asian
 - Native American/Alaskan Native
 - Middle Eastern/North African
 - Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander

2. Broader Weld County Community

- **Age:** Encompassing a wide age range from youth (15-24 years), young adults (25-34 years), middle-aged adults (35-54 years), and older adults (55+ years).
- **Gender Identity:** Inclusive of all gender identities, ensuring programs are accessible and welcoming to everyone.
- **Race/Ethnicity:** Focused on serving the diverse communities within Weld County, including:
 - Hispanic/Latino residents, who have seen an increase in opioid overdose rates.
 - Non-Hispanic residents, including White/Caucasian, African American, Asian, and other ethnic groups.

3. Specific Focus Groups within the Community

- **Working-Age Adults:** Particularly those aged 18-44, who represent the majority of opioid-related emergency department visits in Weld County.
- **High-Risk Populations:** Individuals with a higher risk of opioid misuse, including those with a history of substance use disorder or those in recovery.
- **Teens:** Targeting young college students aged 15-18 to provide early prevention education and support.
- **Underserved Populations:** Including rural residents and low-income individuals who may have limited access to recovery resources and harm reduction services.

4. University of Northern Colorado (UNCo) Staff and Faculty

- **Age:** Primarily adults aged 25-65+.
- **Gender Identity:** Inclusive of all gender identities.

- **Race/Ethnicity:** Reflective of the diverse UNCo staff and faculty, ensuring that support and training programs are accessible to all.

Additional Relevant Information

Language Accessibility:

- **Capacity to Deliver Services in Multiple Languages:** The program will ensure that materials and peer support services are available in both English and Spanish, addressing the significant Hispanic/Latino population in Weld County. Additional language support will be provided as needed, leveraging community resources and translation services.

Cultural Sensitivity and Inclusiveness:

- **Culturally Responsive Programming:** Programs and services will be designed and delivered with cultural sensitivity, recognizing and respecting the diverse backgrounds and experiences of the target populations.
- **Community Engagement:** Active engagement with community leaders and organizations to ensure that program activities are relevant and effectively meet the needs of different cultural groups.

Socioeconomic Considerations:

- **Accessibility:** Ensuring that all program activities are accessible to individuals regardless of their socioeconomic status, including offering free or low-cost services and resources.
- **Support for Uninsured and Underinsured:** Providing information and assistance to help individuals access healthcare and recovery support services, even if they are uninsured or underinsured.

LGBTQ+ Inclusivity:

- **Support for LGBTQ+ Individuals:** Programs will be inclusive and supportive of LGBTQ+ individuals, providing a safe and affirming environment for all participants.

The "You Got A Peer In Me Program" is designed to reach a diverse range of populations within the University of Northern Colorado (UNCo) and the broader Weld County community. By addressing the specific needs of various age groups, gender identities, races/ethnicities, and other relevant demographic factors, the program aims to provide comprehensive and culturally sensitive support to those affected by opioid misuse.

7: Estimate the number of people to be reached with your program's efforts over the whole grant period.

Overview: Sober AF Entertainment (S.AF.E) has developed estimates based on past event attendance and achievable metrics. The "You Got A Peer In Me Program" aims to reach a diverse range of individuals through various activities, including the Collegiate Recovery Program (CRC), sober support events, peer recovery specialist training, and harm reduction education. Below are detailed estimates of the number of people expected to be impacted by the program over the grant period.

University of Northern Colorado (UNCo) Students

1. Students Impacted Through Collegiate Recovery Program (CRC)

- **Estimated Reach:** 200 students
- **Details:** Participation through CRC meetings, recovery coaching, and peer support activities.

2. Students Impacted Through Sober Support Events on Campus

- **Estimated Reach:** 1,600 students
- **Details:** Hosting 8 community-led sober support events, each attracting an average of 200 students.

3. Students Impacted Through Peer Recovery Specialist Training

- **Estimated Reach:** 10-20 students
- **Details:** Certifying 10-20 UNCo students through the Peer Recovery Specialist Training program, equipping them with skills to provide peer support on campus and in the community.

4. Students Impacted Through Harm Reduction Education and Naloxone Training

- **Estimated Reach:** 200 individuals
- **Details:** Conducting regular Naloxone training sessions and harm reduction workshops, with an average of 25 participants per event, totaling 8 events.

Total UNCo Student Reach: 2,000 individuals

Broader Weld County Community

1. Individuals Impacted Through Sober Support Events at Greeley Stampede

- **Estimated Reach:** 800 community members

- **Details:** Hosting 8 partner-led events, each attracting an average of 100 community members, including individuals from the local recovery community and clients from Centennial Peaks Hospital.

2. Individuals Impacted Through Harm Reduction Education and Naloxone Training

- **Estimated Reach:** 200 individuals
- **Details:** Conducting regular Naloxone training sessions and harm reduction workshops at the Greeley Stampede, with an average of 25 participants per event, totaling 8 events.

3. Individuals Impacted Through Marketing and Awareness Campaigns

- **Estimated Reach:** 5,000 individuals
- **Details:** Comprehensive marketing and outreach efforts, including social media campaigns, flyers, and community engagement activities to promote Weld programs and events.

Total Community Reach: 6,000 individuals

Grand Total Estimated Reach: 8,000 Individuals

8: Describe your organization's capacity to access and engage people [being served/who use drugs] in a respectful and culturally responsive manner.

1. Proven Track Record of Success

Experience: Sober AF Entertainment (SAFE) has a strong history of successfully engaging diverse populations through substance-free events and harm reduction programs. Our collaborations with various universities and communities have honed our strategies for effective outreach and engagement.

- **University Collaborations:** SAFE has partnered with numerous universities, including Colorado Mesa University, MSU Denver, Colorado State University, and University of Colorado Boulder, to create inclusive and supportive environments for students in recovery.
- **Community Events:** Our participation in large community events, such as the Greeley Stampede, showcases our ability to reach and engage a broad audience.

2. Inclusive and Culturally Sensitive Programming

Diversity and Inclusion: SAFE is committed to promoting diversity, equity, and inclusion in all our programs. We address the unique cultural contexts and needs of the populations we serve.

- **Multilingual Services:** We offer services and materials in multiple languages to ensure accessibility for non-English speakers, with translation services available at events.
- **Culturally Relevant Resources:** Collaborations with community partners, such as McBride Impact to support African American communities and Tribe Recovery for Hispanic/Latino communities, provide culturally relevant resources and support.

3. Trained and Diverse Staff

Staff Composition: Our team includes individuals from diverse backgrounds, bringing a wide range of perspectives and experiences.

- **Training and Development:** All staff members receive ongoing training in cultural competency, harm reduction, and peer support, ensuring respectful and culturally responsive engagement with participants.
- **Peer Support Specialists:** We train and employ peer support specialists with lived experience in substance use and recovery, helping build trust and rapport with participants.

4. Community Partnerships

Collaborative Approach: SAFE leverages partnerships with local organizations to enhance outreach and engagement efforts, connecting with specific communities and providing tailored support.

- **Examples:**
 - **Gay & Sober:** Providing LGBTQ+ mindful resources and promoting collaborative harm reduction and sober support initiatives.
 - **SAFE Project and Shatterproof:** Expanding opportunities for individuals and students around sober resources, peer support, and harm reduction.
 - **Association for Recovery in Higher Education (ARHE):** Collaborating to expand opportunities for students around sober resources, peer support, and harm reduction.

5. Respectful and Non-Judgmental Engagement

Approach: SAFE adopts a respectful and non-judgmental approach in all interactions with participants, prioritizing a safe and welcoming environment where individuals feel comfortable seeking support.

- **Participant-Centered:** Our programs are designed to be participant-centered, recognizing the autonomy and agency of each individual, and we tailor our support based on their needs and preferences.

6. Evidence-Based Practices

Best Practices: SAFE incorporates evidence-based practices in all programs, ensuring that our approaches are informed by the latest research and proven methods.

- **Continuous Improvement:** We continuously evaluate our programs and seek feedback from participants to improve our services, ensuring responsiveness to community needs.

7. Commitment to Racial Justice, Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion (JEDI)

Internal Practices: SAFE prioritizes JEDI in hiring practices, staff training, and leadership development, building a team that reflects the diversity of the communities we serve.

- **Board Leadership:** Comprising leaders who represent diverse populations, engaged in regular discussions and workshops to deepen their understanding of JEDI principles.
 - 80% Active Recovery (8/10)
 - 30% Women (3/10)
 - 20% LGBTQ+ (2/10)
 - 10% African American (1/10)
 - 10% Indian (1/10)
 - 10% Native American (1/10)
- **Team Leadership:**
 - 83.33% Active Recovery (4/6)
 - 50% Women (3/6)
 - 16.66% Middle Eastern (1/6)

External Practices: SAFE collaborates with diverse community groups to ensure all services are accessible and relevant, particularly for marginalized communities disproportionately affected by substance misuse. Our outreach strategies are tailored to engage diverse populations, and we continuously seek participant feedback to improve and adapt program offerings.

Current Partners Specializing in Diverse Community Reach:

- AEG & Global Dance (Major Venue/Promoter Partner)
- Association for Recovery in Higher Education (Youth in Education Community Partner)
- Centennial Peaks Hospital (Treatment Center Community Partner)
- Colorado Mesa University (Collegiate Recovery Program Partner)
- DEA (Government/Law Enforcement Partner)
- Gay & Sober (LGBTQ+ Community Partner)
- Greeley Stampede (Venue Partner)
- McBride Impact (African American Community Partner)
- Mental Health Partners (Treatment Community Partner/Spanish Speaking Peers)
- SAFE Project (Mental Health Partner)
- Shatterproof (Suicide Prevention Partner)
- RevelXP (College/University Venue Logistics Partner)
- Tribe Recovery (Hispanic/Latin American Community Partner)

Through these efforts, Sober AF Entertainment advocates for a sober lifestyle and champions a more just, equitable, and inclusive society where everyone feels valued and supported in their recovery journey.

9: Describe your organization's capacity to deliver services in languages other than English.

1. Multilingual Services and Materials

Translation and Interpretation Services: Sober AF Entertainment (S.A.F.E) offers translation and interpretation services to ensure non-English speaking participants can fully engage in programs. S.A.F.E collaborates with professional translators and interpreters available at events to assist participants as needed.

Multilingual Materials: All educational and promotional materials, including flyers, brochures, and informational handouts, are available in multiple languages. This ensures participants can access vital information in their preferred language.

2. Diverse and Multilingual Staff

Staff Composition: S.A.F.E employs staff members fluent in various languages, enhancing their ability to communicate effectively with participants from different linguistic backgrounds.

Language Training: S.A.F.E provides language training for staff to improve their proficiency in commonly spoken languages within their service area. This training equips staff to better assist participants in their native languages.

3. Community Partnerships

Collaborations with Multilingual Organizations: S.A.F.E partners with organizations focusing on serving non-English speaking communities. These partnerships help expand our reach and ensure language is not a barrier to accessing services.

- **Examples:**

- **Tribe Recovery:** Collaborating to provide support and resources to Hispanic/Latino communities, including Spanish-speaking individuals.
- **Mental Health Partners Colorado:** Enhancing Spanish outreach and engagement with diverse communities, including those with limited English proficiency.

4. Multilingual Peer Support Specialists

Peer Support Specialists: S.A.F.E trains and employs peer support specialists fluent in multiple languages. These specialists provide culturally and linguistically appropriate support, ensuring participants feel understood and respected.

Role of Peer Specialists: Multilingual peer specialists play a crucial role in facilitating communication, offering emotional support, and connecting participants with resources in their native languages.

10: Describe your organization's capacity to provide ongoing staff training, consistent with training required from a regulatory standpoint.

1. Comprehensive Training Programs

Initial Training: All new staff members at Sober AF Entertainment (S.AF.E) undergo a comprehensive onboarding program that includes training in organizational policies, program objectives, and the specific skills required for their roles.

Ongoing Training: S.AF.E provides regular, ongoing training sessions to ensure staff members remain up-to-date with the latest best practices, regulatory requirements, and developments in the field of substance use recovery and harm reduction.

2. Training Consistent with Regulatory Requirements

Compliance with Regulations: S.AF.E's training programs are designed to comply with all relevant federal, state, and local regulations. This includes training on confidentiality, data security, and compliance with the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) and 42 C.F.R. Part 2 (Confidentiality of Substance Use Disorder Patient Records).

Regulatory Updates: S.AF.E has a dedicated compliance officer who monitors changes in regulations and ensures that training programs are updated accordingly. This ensures that all staff members are aware of and adhere to current legal and regulatory standards.

3. Specialized Training Areas

Cultural Competency: Training sessions on cultural competency equip staff with the skills to engage and support participants from diverse backgrounds in a respectful and culturally responsive manner.

Harm Reduction and Naloxone Training: Staff receive specialized training in harm reduction strategies, including the administration of Naloxone, to effectively support individuals at risk of opioid overdose.

Peer Support: Peer support specialists undergo training certified by the Colorado Providers Association (COPA), ensuring they are well-prepared to provide high-quality support to individuals in recovery.

4. Professional Development Opportunities

Workshops and Conferences: S.AF.E encourages staff to attend workshops, conferences, and seminars relevant to their roles. These opportunities for professional development help staff stay informed about the latest research, trends, and innovations in substance use recovery and harm reduction.

Certification and Continuing Education: Staff are supported in pursuing additional certifications and continuing education courses to enhance their skills and knowledge.

5. Collaboration with External Experts

Partnerships: S.AF.E collaborates with external experts and organizations to deliver specialized training sessions. This includes partnerships with local health departments, universities, and professional associations.

Guest Speakers and Trainers: S.AF.E invites guest speakers and trainers with expertise in relevant areas to conduct workshops and training sessions for S.AF.E's staff.

11: Please elaborate on your current data management systems and whatever procedures and policies are in place to ensure confidentiality, security, as well as compliance with the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 ("HIPAA") and Confidentiality of Substance Use Disorder Patient Records in 42 C.F.R. Part 2 as applicable.

Sober AF Entertainment (S.AF.E) will utilize advanced data collection methods through Airtable and Fillout Enterprise to gather feedback and assess the program's effectiveness. This data is crucial for making informed decisions, improving future programs, and fulfilling reporting requirements for grant funders.

Data Management Systems and Compliance

1. Data Management Systems

Centralized Database: S.AF.E uses a secure, centralized database to store and manage all participant data, event information, and program metrics. This database is accessible only to authorized personnel, ensuring data integrity and confidentiality.

QR Code-Enabled Data Collection: At events, S.AF.E uses QR code-enabled login forms to streamline data collection. This method allows for real-time input and minimizes errors associated with manual data entry.

Cloud-Based Solutions: S.AF.E utilizes cloud-based solutions that offer advanced security features, including encryption and access controls, to store and manage data. These solutions are compliant with HIPAA and other relevant regulations.

2. Confidentiality and Security Policies

Data Encryption: All sensitive data, both in transit and at rest, is encrypted using industry-standard encryption protocols to protect data from unauthorized access and breaches.

Access Controls: S.AF.E implements strict access controls to ensure that only authorized personnel have access to sensitive information. Role-based access ensures that individuals can only access data necessary for their job functions.

Regular Audits: S.AF.E conducts regular audits of its data management systems and security protocols to identify and address any potential vulnerabilities. These audits are performed by internal staff as well as third-party security experts.

3. Compliance with HIPAA and 42 C.F.R. Part 2

HIPAA Compliance: S.AF.E is committed to complying with the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA). Policies and procedures are designed to protect the privacy and security of participants' health information.

Training: All staff members receive regular training on HIPAA requirements and the importance of protecting health information, including understanding the Privacy Rule and the Security Rule under HIPAA.

Policies: S.AF.E's HIPAA compliance policies include guidelines for the use, disclosure, and safeguarding of protected health information (PHI), ensuring all disclosures of PHI are compliant with HIPAA regulations.

42 C.F.R. Part 2 Compliance: S.AF.E adheres to the Confidentiality of Substance Use Disorder Patient Records regulations under 42 C.F.R. Part 2, which provides additional privacy protections for individuals receiving substance use disorder treatment.

Consent and Authorization: S.AF.E obtains written consent from participants before disclosing any information covered by 42 C.F.R. Part 2, ensuring participants have control over who can access their information.

Additional Protections: Policies include specific procedures for handling and disclosing information related to substance use disorder treatment, ensuring compliance with all legal requirements.

4. Data Privacy and Participant Rights

Privacy Notices: S.AF.E provides participants with clear and comprehensive privacy notices that explain their rights and S.AF.E's obligations under HIPAA and 42 C.F.R. Part 2. These notices are available in multiple languages to ensure accessibility.

Right to Access and Amend: Participants have the right to access their personal data and request amendments if they believe there are inaccuracies. S.AF.E has established procedures to handle such requests promptly and efficiently.

Breach Notification: In the unlikely event of a data breach, S.AF.E has a breach notification policy in place to inform affected individuals and take appropriate corrective actions.

5. Data Retention and Disposal

Retention Policies: S.AF.E's data retention policies specify the duration for which different types of data are kept, designed to comply with legal requirements and best practices.

Secure Disposal: S.AF.E uses secure methods for disposing of data that is no longer needed, ensuring that sensitive information is irreversibly destroyed. This includes shredding physical documents and using data wiping tools for electronic records.

6. Continuous Improvement

Feedback and Improvement: S.AF.E continuously seeks feedback from participants and staff to improve data management practices, helping the organization stay responsive to changing needs and regulatory requirements.

Technological Advancements: S.AF.E keeps abreast of technological advancements and incorporates new tools and practices that enhance data security and compliance.

12: ONLY if your organization will be providing direct health services (including behavioral health and/or substance use treatment): please describe your fee schedule, payors, if/how you serve uninsured and underinsured, type of services offered, and qualifications for providers (i.e., RN, LPC, CADAC, LCADAC, etc.)

Not Applicable

13: Describe the evaluation plan for your proposed work. Include at least one evaluation question per objective. Describe how your proposal is informed by nationally recognized outcomes, best practices, established evidence, or supported by research.

Objective 1: Develop and Grow the Collegiate Recovery Program (CRC) at the University of Northern Colorado (UNCo)

Evaluation Questions:

1. How many students participated in CRC activities over the grant period?
2. What changes in attitudes toward recovery and sobriety were observed among UNCo students?
3. What were the retention and engagement rates of students in the CRC?

Evaluation Methods:

- **Participant Tracking:** Use sign-in sheets and QR code-enabled forms to track student participation in CRC activities.
- **Pre-and Post-Surveys:** Administer surveys before and after participation in CRC activities to measure changes in attitudes and perceptions.
- **Engagement Metrics:** Analyze data on attendance, participation in events, and use of CRC resources to assess retention and engagement rates.

Objective 2: Curate, Market, and Execute a Series of 16 Community-Led Events Promoting Sober Support and Harm Reduction

Evaluation Questions:

1. How many individuals attended the community-led events?
2. How did participants rate the usefulness and impact of the harm reduction education provided?
3. What was the level of participant satisfaction with the events?

Evaluation Methods:

- **Attendance Records:** Maintain records of attendance at each event.
- **Participant Feedback Surveys:** Collect feedback from attendees using QR code-enabled surveys to assess the perceived usefulness and impact of the harm reduction education.
- **Satisfaction Ratings:** Include questions in the surveys to gauge participant satisfaction with various aspects of the events, such as content, organization, and overall experience.

Objective 3: Provide Ongoing Peer Support and Harm Reduction Education, Including Naloxone Training and Distribution

Evaluation Questions:

1. How many individuals received Naloxone training and kits?
2. What percentage of trained individuals reported increased confidence in administering Naloxone?
3. How many opioid overdose reversals were reported as a result of the distributed Naloxone kits?

Evaluation Methods:

- **Training Records:** Keep detailed records of Naloxone training sessions and the number of kits distributed.
- **Follow-Up Surveys:** Administer follow-up surveys to training participants to assess their confidence in administering Naloxone and gather data on any overdose reversals.
- **Outcome Tracking:** Work with local health departments and partners to track reported overdose reversals.

Objective 4: Facilitate Internships and Peer Support Certification for UNCo Students

Evaluation Questions:

1. How many students completed the Peer Recovery Specialist Training program?
2. What were the employment or volunteer outcomes for students after training?
3. How did the internships impact students' skills and knowledge in peer support?

Evaluation Methods:

- **Certification Records:** Track the number of students who complete the training and receive certification.
- **Post-Certification Surveys:** Survey students after certification to gather data on their employment or volunteer activities and their perceived impact of the training on their skills and knowledge.
- **Internship Feedback:** Collect feedback from interns and their supervisors to evaluate the effectiveness of the internship program in enhancing skills and knowledge.

Informed by Nationally Recognized Outcomes, Best Practices, and Established Evidence

Nationally Recognized Outcomes:

- **SAMHSA's Strategic Prevention Framework:** S.A.F.E.'s program aligns with the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration's (SAMHSA) framework, focusing on comprehensive, data-driven approaches to prevention and recovery.
- **National Institute on Drug Abuse (NIDA) Research:** S.A.F.E. incorporates evidence-based practices supported by NIDA research, such as peer support models and harm reduction strategies.

Best Practices:

- **Peer Support:** Utilizing best practices from the peer support model, which has been shown to improve recovery outcomes and enhance social support networks.
- **Harm Reduction:** Following harm reduction principles that prioritize the health and safety of individuals, reduce the negative consequences of substance use, and promote engagement with health services.

Established Evidence:

- **Evidence-Based Training Programs:** S.AF.E's Peer Recovery Specialist Training program is based on established curricula that have demonstrated effectiveness in preparing individuals to provide peer support through COPA.
- **Data-Driven Decision Making:** S.AF.E uses a data-driven approach to continuously improve programs, guided by insights from participant feedback and outcome evaluations.

14: Please include an outcome objective statement that describes how your plan affects/changes attitudes, knowledge, or behaviors in the community, and how this will be measured.

The college experience is often associated with newfound freedoms, exploration, and unfortunately, exposure to substance use. Recognizing the unique challenges and pressures faced by students, Sober AF Entertainment (S.AF.E) serves as a platform for vital prevention and education strategies for recovery communities, peer support, and harm reduction.

Collegiate Recovery Communities (CRCs) offer significant benefits for students navigating recovery from addiction while pursuing their academic goals. These programs provide a supportive and safe environment embedded within the college or university's structure, often as part of the school's counseling or mental health services. Students play a crucial role in developing CRCs, which offer physical spaces for socialization, on-campus support group meetings, and access to advising and counseling specialists familiar with the recovery process. CRCs are designed to help students maintain their recovery and continue their education, benefiting not only the students but also the universities, their families, and society.

The support network provided by CRCs, including pro-recovery peers, is crucial in preventing relapse, particularly in the early stages of recovery. These programs embody a holistic view of recovery, emphasizing wellness and personal growth beyond mere abstinence. Institutions are increasingly prioritizing student health and well-being, acknowledging the connection between academic success and physical and mental health. By integrating recovery support into the academic setting, CRCs allow students to pursue their education without having to choose between their recovery and their academic aspirations.

Outcome Objective Statement

The "You Got A Peer In Me Program" aims to positively affect attitudes, increase knowledge, and change behaviors related to substance use and recovery within the University of Northern Colorado (UNCo) and the broader Weld County community. By implementing comprehensive peer support, harm reduction education, and recovery initiatives, S.AF.E intends to:

Change Attitudes: Reduce stigma associated with substance use and recovery by fostering a supportive and inclusive community environment. This will be measured through pre- and

post-program surveys assessing changes in participant attitudes towards substance use and recovery.

Increase Knowledge: Enhance understanding of harm reduction strategies, recovery resources, and opioid overdose prevention. This will be measured by participant knowledge assessments conducted before and after educational sessions and training programs.

Change Behaviors: Encourage healthier behaviors by increasing engagement in recovery support services, promoting safe substance use practices, and enhancing peer support networks. This will be measured through tracking participation rates in CRC activities, harm reduction training, and sober support events, as well as follow-up surveys evaluating behavior changes.

Measurement Methods

Pre- and Post-Program Surveys:

- **Attitude Surveys:** Conduct surveys before and after participation in CRC activities and community events to assess changes in attitudes towards substance use and recovery. Questions will focus on perceptions of stigma, willingness to engage in recovery support, and openness to harm reduction strategies.
- **Knowledge Assessments:** Administer assessments to measure participants' knowledge of harm reduction techniques, recovery resources, and Naloxone administration before and after training sessions. These assessments will include both multiple-choice and open-ended questions to gauge understanding.

Participation Tracking:

- **Event Attendance:** Record attendance at all CRC activities, community-led events, and harm reduction training sessions using sign-in sheets and QR code-enabled forms. This data will help quantify engagement levels and identify trends in participation.
- **Service Utilization:** Track the utilization of recovery support services, including peer coaching sessions, support group attendance, and use of CRC resources. This information will be collected through service logs and participant feedback forms.

Follow-Up Surveys:

- **Behavioral Surveys:** Conduct follow-up surveys with participants at regular intervals (e.g., 3 months, 6 months, 12 months) to assess long-term behavior changes. Questions will address changes in substance use habits, engagement in recovery activities, and application of harm reduction practices.
- **Outcome Tracking:** Collect data on specific outcomes, such as the number of opioid overdose reversals reported, the number of individuals completing peer support certification, and the overall satisfaction with the program's impact on personal recovery journeys.

Summary

The outcome objective statement for the "You Got A Peer In Me Program" outlines S.AF.E's goals to change attitudes, increase knowledge, and alter behaviors related to substance use and recovery. Through a combination of surveys, participation tracking, and follow-up assessments, S.AF.E will measure the program's effectiveness in achieving these objectives and driving positive change within the UNCo and Weld County communities.

Additional Attachment: S.AF.E Data Metrics

- **Total Events:** 233
- **Total Live Reach:** 19,380
- **Total Training Attendees:** 9,027
- **Total Virtual Viewers:** 45,488
- **Total Peer Specialist Opportunities:** 600
- **Total Peer Training Hours:** 2,071
- **Total Peer Interactions:** 1,590
- **Total Peer Referrals:** 545
- **Total Peer Interest Generated:** 283
- **Total Orgs Communicated With:** 1,417
- **Total Naloxone Trainings:** 50
- **Total Naloxone Kits Distributed:** 984
- **Total Fentanyl Test Strips Distributed:** 630
- **Total Donated Tickets:** 3,405
- **Total Submissions:** 902

Total Ethnicity Submissions: 902

- **African American Attendees:** 60 (7%)
- **American Indian/Alaskan Native Attendees:** 60 (7%)
- **Asian Attendees:** 9 (1%)
- **Hispanic/Latino Attendees:** 139 (15%)
- **Middle Eastern/North African Attendees:** 8 (1%)
- **Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander Attendees:** 3 (0%)
- **White/Caucasian Attendees:** 683 (76%)

Total Gender Submissions: 787

- **Female Attendees:** 390 (50%)
- **Male Attendees:** 386 (49%)
- **Transgender Female Attendees:** 3 (0%)
- **Transgender Male Attendees:** 1 (0%)
- **Gender Variant/Non-Conforming Attendees:** 6 (1%)
- **Non-Binary Attendees:** 1 (0%)

Total Age Submissions: 948

- **0-17 Attendees:** 13 (1%)
- **18-25 Attendees:** 70 (7%)
- **26-30 Attendees:** 102 (11%)
- **31-45 Attendees:** 491 (52%)
- **46-64 Attendees:** 245 (26%)
- **65+ Attendees:** 26 (3%)

Total Increased Skills/Awareness Submissions: 743

- **3 or Higher:** 607 (82%)
- **5:** 352 (47%)
- **4:** 108 (15%)
- **3:** 147 (20%)
- **2:** 36 (5%)
- **1:** 24 (3%)
- **Not At All:** 76 (10%)

Total Supported My Sobriety Submissions: 700

- **3 or Higher:** 585 (84%)
- **5:** 342 (49%)
- **4:** 95 (14%)
- **3:** 148 (21%)
- **2:** 37 (5%)
- **1:** 54 (8%)
- **Not At All:** 24 (3%)

Total Improved Mental Wellbeing Submissions: 158

- **3 or Higher:** 132 (84%)
- **5:** 97 (61%)
- **4:** 14 (9%)
- **3:** 21 (13%)
- **2:** 3 (2%)
- **1:** 2 (1%)
- **Not At All:** 21 (13%)

Total Increased My Substance-Free Social Interaction Submissions: 157

- **3 or Higher:** 128 (82%)
- **5:** 95 (61%)
- **4:** 10 (6%)
- **3:** 23 (15%)

- **2:** 7 (4%)
- **1:** 1 (1%)
- **Not At All:** 21 (13%)

Total Improved Positive Public Stigma Submissions: 155

- **3 or Higher:** 124 (80%)
- **5:** 93 (60%)
- **4:** 9 (6%)
- **3:** 22 (14%)
- **2:** 5 (3%)
- **1:** 5 (3%)
- **Not At All:** 21 (14%)

Total Gained New Relationships/Support Outlets Submissions: 159

- **3 or Higher:** 131 (82%)
- **5:** 96 (60%)
- **4:** 11 (7%)
- **3:** 24 (15%)
- **2:** 2 (1%)
- **1:** 4 (3%)
- **Not At All:** 22 (14%)

Total Events Attended Submissions: 735

- **No Events:** 159 (22%)
- **1 Event:** 277 (38%)
- **2 Events:** 79 (11%)
- **3 Events:** 116 (16%)
- **4 Events:** 80 (11%)
- **5 Events:** 4 (1%)
- **6 Events:** 2 (0%)
- **7 Events:** 2 (0%)
- **8 Events:** 0 (0%)
- **9 Events:** 1 (0%)
- **10 Events:** 3 (0%)
- **More Than 10 Events:** 5 (1%)
- **As Many Events As I Can:** 7 (1%)

Total Did You Know Of Sober Events Submissions: 369

- **No:** 207 (56%)
- **Not In Fun Places:** 22 (6%)
- **Yes:** 140 (38%)

Total Referral Sources Submissions: 217

- **Co-Worker/Colleague:** 10 (5%)
- **Duke Rumely:** 35 (16%)
- **Email:** 7 (3%)
- **Flyer:** 1 (0%)
- **Friend/Family:** 36 (17%)
- **Google/Web Search:** 3 (1%)
- **Livestreams:** 1 (0%)
- **Previous Event:** 27 (12%)
- **Recovery/Sober Network:** 10 (5%)
- **S.AF.E Team:** 0 (0%)
- **School/University:** 0 (0%)
- **Social Media:** 10 (5%)
- **Support Group:** 75 (35%)
- **Other:** 2 (1%)

Total Favorite Events Submissions: 771

- **All Events:** 92 (12%)
- **Charity Fundraisers:** 0 (0%)
- **Community Celebrations:** 288 (37%)
- **Concerts:** 492 (64%)
- **Conferences/Industry Meetings:** 20 (3%)
- **Cultural/Diversity Appreciation:** 135 (18%)
- **Fitness/Wellness:** 272 (35%)
- **Group Meet-Ups/Meetings:** 221 (29%)
- **Livestreams/Virtual:** 10 (1%)
- **Movies/Watch Parties:** 258 (33%)
- **Music Open Mic:** 0 (0%)
- **Music/Arts Festivals:** 397 (51%)
- **Nature/Outdoor:** 271 (35%)
- **Sporting Events College:** 0 (0%)
- **Sporting Events Pro:** 0 (0%)
- **Trainings/Workshops:** 218 (28%)
- **Volunteering:** 30 (4%)

Total Favorite Resources Submissions: 615

- **All Resources:** 35 (6%)
- **African American Focused:** 25 (4%)
- **Collegiate Recovery Student:** 23 (4%)
- **Community Building:** 306 (50%)
- **Culturally Mindful:** 201 (33%)
- **Female Focused:** 43 (7%)

- **Harm Reduction:** 217 (35%)
- **Latinx Focused:** 15 (2%)
- **LGBTQ Focused:** 32 (5%)
- **Music Focused:** 60 (10%)
- **Peer Support:** 312 (51%)
- **Rural Focused:** 103 (17%)
- **Substance Abuse:** 371 (60%)
- **Youth Focused:** 39 (6%)

Total Favorite Trainings Submissions: 405

- **All Trainings:** 29 (7%)
- **Emergency/Medical Training:** 160 (40%)
- **Harm Reduction Training:** 173 (43%)
- **Peer Support Training:** 261 (64%)
- **Recovery Community Impact Training:** 226 (56%)
- **Sober Event Curation Training:** 214 (53%)